

Onboarding & Transition

Sales Signature Through CS Ownership

Purpose

Get a new account from signed contract to fully CS-owned without a single moment where the customer doesn't know who to call, and without CS meeting the account cold at go-live.

Trigger Points & Owners

Stage	Trigger	Owner	Timing
Internal loop-in	Deal enters late stage, pre-signature	Sales → named CS	Before signature
Joint kickoff	Contract signed	Sales, Implementation, CS (joint call)	Within 3 business days of signature
Implementation phase	Ongoing	Implementation leads; CS stays lightly visible	Through build
Defined transition	Go-live + fixed stabilization window (e.g. 2 weeks)	Implementation → CS, joint call	A date, not a feeling
CS-led relationship	Transition complete	Named CS	Ongoing

Step-by-Step Process

- 1. Pre-signature loop-in (internal only)** Sales briefs the assigned CS before the customer ever meets them: who the stakeholders are, what was promised (including anything verbal, not just what's in the contract), and what "success" means to this specific customer. The customer never sees this step — it exists so CS walks into kickoff already knowing the account instead of meeting it cold.
- 2. Joint kickoff call** Sales, Implementation, and the named CS are all on the call together — the customer meets everyone at once, not in stages. Implementation facilitates, since this is their phase. CS is introduced and speaks briefly — presence, not airtime. Talking too much here creates "who do I actually call" confusion during the build.
Kickoff deck contents: project timeline and milestones; a roles slide (who does what — the single most important slide in the deck); success criteria agreed with Sales; communication cadence; what's needed from the customer and by when.
- 3. Implementation phase** Implementation owns day-to-day execution — configuration, technical work, milestone tracking. CS keeps a light, defined cadence: one mid-implementation check-in call, visible (not leading) on major milestone reviews. By go-live, the customer has already had one or two real interactions with CS.
- 4. The defined transition** Trigger is go-live plus a fixed stabilization window — a date on the calendar, not a subjective call. Joint transition call, customer present. Implementation hands over a written health baseline: what's configured, what's still open, and which stakeholders were actually engaged during onboarding versus who signed. CS formally takes ownership *on this call, in front of the customer* — never a quiet internal handoff. After this call, Implementation is out except for items already logged.
- 5. First-quarter CS ownership** 30/60/90-day check-ins focused on adoption depth, not just "everything okay?" Ongoing check against the success criteria set at kickoff — is usage matching what the customer actually signed up for, not just whether they're logging in.

Friction Points to Design Against

- **Role confusion at kickoff** — solved by CS's deliberately small airtime on the joint call
- **Implementation feeling supervised** — solved by framing CS's mid-build touch as a check-in, never a status audit
- **Ambiguous go-live** — solved by the fixed stabilization window, removing subjective judgment calls
- **Customer repeating themselves** — solved by the written baseline handoff, so CS never asks a question Implementation already has the answer to

Artifacts

- Pre-signature briefing note (Sales → CS)
- Kickoff deck template
- Written health baseline template (Implementation → CS)
- 30/60/90-day check-in checklist